

# Week 6 Cram Sheet

## Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

### 1 · Framework

| Method           | Uses                                                         |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Inspection       | Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue) |
| Auscult./Olfact. | Ears (listen) + nose (smell)                                 |
| Inquiry          | Verbal questioning                                           |
| Palpation        | Touch, incl. pulse                                           |

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

### 2 · Shen (Vitality)

| Finding               | Meaning        |
|-----------------------|----------------|
| Clear, sparkling eyes | Shen present   |
| Dull, cloudy eyes     | Shen disturbed |

### 3 · Five Colors of Face

| Color           | Indication                                                            |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Red             | Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)                     |
| Pale/White      | Cold, blood/yang deficiency                                           |
| Yellow          | Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice) |
| Blue-Green      | Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion                                    |
| Dark Grey/Black | Kidney deficiency, blood stasis                                       |

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

**Heads Up** — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.

### Secretions: Color Rule

| Finding       | Meaning     |
|---------------|-------------|
| Clear/white   | Def./cold   |
| Turbid/yellow | Excess/heat |

### 4 · Appearance & Movement

| Finding                         | Pattern                    |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Overweight + depression         | Qi def. + phlegm-damp      |
| Thin + dry skin                 | Blood insufficiency        |
| Active movement                 | Yang syndrome              |
| Passive manner                  | Yin syndrome               |
| Muscle weakness/atrophy         | Wei syndrome               |
| Pain+swelling+restricted joints | Bi syndrome                |
| One-sided numbness              | Hemiplegia/wind-stroke     |
| Tremors/convulsions             | Wind                       |
| Stiffness/rigidity              | Qi stag./blood stasis/wind |

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yin deficiency.

### 5 · Eyes: Five Wheels

| Wheel | Structure           | Organ          |
|-------|---------------------|----------------|
| Blood | Inner/outer canthus | Heart          |
| Qi    | Sclera              | Lung           |
| Wind  | Iris                | Liver          |
| Water | Pupil               | Kidney         |
| Flesh | Eyelids             | Spleen/Stomach |

**Heads Up** — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.

### 6 · Nose

Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).

| Finding             | Pattern                       |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|
| Green/blue tip      | Cold                          |
| Yellow tip          | Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)  |
| White tip           | Blood deficiency              |
| Red tip             | Heat                          |
| Gray tip            | Impaired water → edema        |
| Green bridge        | Liver Qi stagnation           |
| Dark purple bridge  | Blood stasis                  |
| Red bridge          | Liver fire                    |
| Flaring nostrils    | Extreme heat                  |
| Epistaxis           | Excess heat, blood forced out |
| Swollen/Sunken nose | Excess/Deficiency             |

| Edema Starts In | Organ  |
|-----------------|--------|
| Upper body/head | Lung   |
| Lower body/feet | Kidney |
| 4 limbs/torso   | Spleen |

### 7 · Ears

Kidney opens to ear.

| Finding                    | Pattern                  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| Dry/withered/black auricle | Kidney essence exhausted |
| Purulent discharge         | Damp-heat Liver/GB       |
| Thin ear                   | Qi/Blood deficiency      |
| Long full earlobes         | Strong constitution      |
| Small earlobes             | Poor constitution        |
| White/pale                 | Cold                     |
| Black                      | Kidney failure           |
| Red                        | Excess heat              |

| Tinnitus            | Organ  |
|---------------------|--------|
| High-pitch (cicada) | Liver  |
| Low-pitch (water)   | Kidney |

### 8 · Teeth/Gums/Lips/Throat

| Teeth Finding        | Pattern                  |
|----------------------|--------------------------|
| White, moist, bright | Strong Kidney Qi         |
| Dry, no sheen        | Kidney Yin decline       |
| Sudden dull yellow   | Kidney deficiency        |
| Gray/black           | Yin+Yang exhaustion      |
| Deviated growth      | Insufficient Yangming Qi |

| Gums/Lips/Mouth          | Pattern          |
|--------------------------|------------------|
| Pale gums/lips           | Blood deficiency |
| Deep red + swelling gums | Stomach fire     |
| Purple lips              | Blood stasis     |
| Crimson lips             | Yin-def. heat    |
| Deviated mouth           | Wind             |
| Mouth remains open+fever | Excess heat      |
| Mouth slightly open      | Deficiency       |

| Eye Color                      | Pattern                         |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Yellow (bright)                | Damp-heat, heat predom.         |
| Red                            | Heart/Liver fire                |
| Blue-green                     | Liver wind                      |
| Bluish                         | Internal cold / Kidney Yin def. |
| Dark/black sclera              | Accumulated heat                |
| White rings                    | Turbid phlegm                   |
|                                |                                 |
| Eye Shape/Move                 | Pattern                         |
| Bulging/protruding             | Liver Yang rising               |
| Sunken                         | Lung/Spleen deficiency          |
| Swollen, sudden                | Fluid malfunction               |
| Strabismus, sudden, no redness | Wind attacking channels         |
| Ptosis (droopy lid)            | Qi sinking or wind              |
| Spasms + pale + thready pulse  | Blood deficiency                |

| Throat/Tonsils            | Pattern                          |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Acute red+swollen         | Wind invasion (exterior)         |
| Chronic red+swollen       | Interior Stomach heat            |
| Dry, NOT swollen, chronic | Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat |

### 9 • Hair, Nails, Skin

| Hair/Nails                     | Pattern                           |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Premature graying              | Kidney essence depletion          |
| Dull, brittle hair             | Liver Blood deficiency            |
| Nail pink, blanch returns fast | Sufficient Qi/Blood               |
| Blanch returns slow            | Qi/Blood exhaustion               |
| Ridged nails                   | Kidney Yin def./Liver Yang rising |
| Spoon-shaped nails             | Qi/Blood stag., Spleen def.       |

| Skin              | Pattern                   |
|-------------------|---------------------------|
| Yellow orangish   | Damp-heat, heat > damp    |
| Yellow dusky      | Damp-heat, damp > heat    |
| Pitting edema     | Yang def. (Spleen/Kidney) |
| Non-pitting edema | Qi stagnation/dampness    |

### 10 • Secretions/Excretions Logic (applies to nasal d/c, sputum, stool, vaginal d/c)

| Axis        | Cold/Deficient      | Hot/Excess    |
|-------------|---------------------|---------------|
| Color       | White               | Yellow        |
| Consistency | Thin, clear, watery | Thick, sticky |
| Quantity    | Profuse             | Scanty        |
| Odor        | None/faint          | Strong        |

### 11 • Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis (age <3)

| Gate Reached          | Severity           | Side               | Sex   |
|-----------------------|--------------------|--------------------|-------|
| Wind Gate only        | Mild / exterior    | Left index finger  | Boys  |
| Qi Gate               | Interior, stronger | Right index finger | Girls |
| Life Gate             | Severe             | —                  | —     |
| Past Life Gate to tip | Life-threatening   | —                  | —     |

| Vein Color      | Indication           |
|-----------------|----------------------|
| Light red       | Normal               |
| Bright red      | Heat                 |
| Purple          | Stronger heat/stasis |
| Green/dark blue | Wind                 |

**Heads Up** — Prof. Lao stated directly: **"Nothing on the body constitutions"** will be tested. Skip Five-Element constitutional typing in your cram pass.